

Alex Rivera

Full-Stack Engineer · Open Source Contributor · DevOps Enthusiast

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ABOUT ME

Full-stack engineer with 8 years of experience building scalable web applications and developer tools. Core contributor to two popular open source projects (combined 15K+ GitHub stars). Passionate about developer experience, infrastructure as code, and making complex systems simple. Previously at Stripe and Vercel, now leading engineering at a Berlin-based fintech startup. I write about distributed systems and Rust on my blog, which gets 50K+ monthly readers.

"Ship fast, ship safe, ship often."

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages

TypeScript, Rust, Go, Python, SQL, Bash

Frontend

React, Next.js 15, Svelte, Tailwind CSS, Radix UI, Storybook

Backend

Node.js, Fastify, tRPC, GraphQL, gRPC, Actix-web (Rust)

Databases

PostgreSQL, Redis, ClickHouse, DynamoDB, Prisma, Drizzle ORM

Infrastructure

AWS (ECS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront), Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions

Observability

Grafana, Prometheus, OpenTelemetry, Sentry, Datadog

WORK EXPERIENCE

Head of Engineering

2023 – Present | Konto — Berlin, Germany

- Lead a team of 12 engineers building a next-gen digital banking platform for SMBs in Europe
- Architected event-driven microservices system processing 2M+ transactions/month with 99.99% uptime
- Introduced trunk-based development and feature flags, reducing deployment cycle from 2 weeks to 45 minutes

- Built internal developer platform with self-service environments, cutting onboarding time from 5 days to 4 hours
- Migrated legacy Java monolith to TypeScript + Rust services, reducing infrastructure cost by 40%

Tags: TypeScript, Rust, PostgreSQL, Kubernetes, Terraform, Event Sourcing

Senior Software Engineer

2021 – 2023 | Vercel — Remote (San Francisco)

- Core team member on Next.js framework — contributed to App Router, Server Components, and Turbopack integration
- Designed and shipped the Edge Middleware runtime, adopted by 100K+ production deployments
- Built the real-time collaboration engine for Vercel's dashboard (WebSocket + CRDT-based)
- Mentored 6 junior engineers; 3 promoted to senior within 18 months
- Authored 15+ RFC documents that shaped Next.js roadmap decisions

Tags: Next.js, React, Edge Computing, WebSocket, CRDT, Turbopack

Software Engineer

2018 – 2021 | Stripe — Dublin, Ireland

- Built payment processing pipelines handling \$50B+ annual volume across 40+ countries
- Designed Stripe's internal A/B testing framework, used by 200+ engineers across 30 teams
- Reduced payment latency by 35% through connection pooling optimization and query rewriting
- On-call rotation lead for Payments Core — maintained 99.999% availability SLA

Tags: Ruby, Go, PostgreSQL, Kafka, AWS, Distributed Systems

Junior Developer

2016 – 2018 | ThoughtWorks — Barcelona, Spain

- Delivered 4 client projects in healthcare and fintech domains using agile/XP practices
- Introduced automated accessibility testing pipeline, achieving WCAG 2.1 AA compliance

Tags: Java, React, CI/CD, Pair Programming, Agile

OPEN SOURCE & SIDE PROJECTS

Patchwork — Git-native Code Review Tool

2022 – Present | github.com/arivera-dev/patchwork

- CLI-first code review tool that works with any Git host (GitHub, GitLab, Gitea)
- Built in Rust with a TUI interface; 8,200+ GitHub stars, 400+ contributors
- Featured in Hacker News front page (twice), ThoughtWorks Tech Radar "Assess" ring
- Weekly downloads: 12K+ via cargo install

Tags: Rust, CLI, Git, TUI, Open Source

SQLens — Visual SQL Query Analyzer

2023 | github.com/arivera-dev/sqlens

- Web-based tool that visualizes SQL query execution plans with performance suggestions
- Supports PostgreSQL, MySQL, and ClickHouse; 6,800+ GitHub stars
- Used by database teams at 3 Fortune 500 companies (per GitHub issues)

Tags: TypeScript, React, PostgreSQL, Query Optimization

alexrivera.dev/blog — Technical Blog

2019 – Present | alexrivera.dev/blog

- 50,000+ monthly readers; 120+ articles on distributed systems, Rust, and developer tooling
- Top posts: "Why We Rewrote Our Backend in Rust" (280K views), "Event Sourcing is Not Event Streaming" (150K views)
- Syndicated on Dev.to (18K followers), Hacker News, and InfoQ

Tags: Technical Writing, Rust, Distributed Systems, Developer Education

DevDash — Developer Dashboard Chrome Extension

2024 | [Chrome Web Store](#) | github.com/arivera-dev/devdash

- New tab replacement showing GitHub notifications, CI/CD status, and Hacker News feed
- 15,000+ active users, 4.8/5 rating on Chrome Web Store

Tags: Chrome Extension, TypeScript, GitHub API

EDUCATION

Technical University of Munich (TUM)

M.Sc. Computer Science · 2014–2016

- Thesis: "Consistent Hashing in Distributed Stream Processing Systems"
- DAAD Scholarship recipient (Top 2%)
- Teaching assistant for Distributed Systems and Database Systems courses

University of Buenos Aires (UBA)

B.Sc. Computer Science · 2010–2014

- Graduated with honors (top 5% of class)
- Undergraduate research: graph database query optimization

SPEAKING & CONFERENCES

- **RustConf 2024** (Montreal) — "Building a 10K-Star CLI Tool: Lessons from Patchwork"
- **Next.js Conf 2023** (San Francisco) — "Inside Edge Middleware: Architecture Deep Dive"
- **KubeCon EU 2023** (Amsterdam) — "From Monolith to Event-Driven: A Fintech Migration Story"
- **DevOpsDays Berlin 2022** — "Developer Platforms That Actually Work"
- **GraphQL Conf 2021** (Virtual) — "Scaling GraphQL at Stripe"
- **JSConf EU 2019** (Berlin) — "Real-time Collaboration Without the Complexity"

PUBLICATIONS & MEDIA

- InfoQ (2024) — "Rust in Production: Real-World Performance at a Fintech Startup"
- The New Stack (2023) — "Why Edge Computing Changes Everything for Web Frameworks"
- Increment by Stripe (2021) — "Designing Payment Systems for Global Scale"
- Dev.to (2019–present) — 18K followers, 120+ articles, 3x Top Author badge
- Stack Overflow — 45K+ reputation, top 0.5% contributor, gold badges in TypeScript and PostgreSQL

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- 2024 — GitHub Stars program member
- 2024 — ThoughtWorks Tech Radar — Patchwork listed in "Assess" ring
- 2023 — Vercel Ship Award — Most Impactful Internal Tool
- 2022 — Hacker News #1 front page (Patchwork launch)
- 2016 — DAAD Scholarship, TU Munich
- 2014 — Best Undergraduate Thesis, UBA Computer Science

INTERESTS

Mechanical keyboards (custom 40% builds) · Rock climbing (6c+ lead) · Specialty coffee (home roasting) · Board games (weekly Terraforming Mars group) · Contributing to Rust compiler (occasional) · Amateur radio (callsign DL7ARV) · Running (Berlin Marathon 2024 finisher, 3:42)